

PANEL 1/12 · CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND RESPONSIBILITY CHAIN

PEOPLE -> PARLIAMENT -> PRESIDENT [Art 53 formal vesting; Art 77 formal action]

-> PM + COUNCIL [Arts 74-75 aid/advice + Lok Sabha responsibility]

-> MINISTRY / DEPARTMENT [Art 77(3) business rules]

-> SECRETARIAT / DELIVERY BODY -> CITIZEN / OUTCOME

TEST: authority + procedure + political owner + official record + review must be identifiable.

PANEL 2/12 · ARTICLE MAP

Art 53 = vesting/exercise according to Constitution; not personal file rule.
Art 73 = Union executive extent; legislative-field/treaty reach subject to federal limits.
Art 74 = PM-led Council aids/advises President.
Art 75 = appointment/tenure/oaths/collective responsibility; 75(1A) ministry-size ceiling.
Art 77 = President's name + authentication + allocation/transaction rules.
Art 78 = PM-President communication/information and Council-placement duty.
Art 88 = minister/AG participation in either House; vote only if member.
Art 300 = Government of India sues/is sued as Union of India; not complete liability code.

PANEL 3/12 · AOB VERSUS TOB

ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES, 1961

WHO OWNS WHAT?

Rule 2 + First Schedule = units

Rule 3 + Second Schedule = subjects

includes linked offices/organisations

permits notification-based reorganisation

BOTH under Art 77(3); NEITHER overrides Constitution or parent statute.

TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES, 1961

HOW IS IT DECIDED?

Rule 3 = departmental disposal

Rule 4 = concurrence/Finance consultation

Rule 7 = Cabinet cases

Schedules: Committee/Cabinet/PM-President routes

PANEL 4/12 · POLITICAL AND PERMANENT EXECUTIVE

PM -> portfolio allocation/coordination

Cabinet Minister / MoS independent charge / assisting MoS = political arrangement.

MINISTER: democratic priority + lawful policy choice + Parliament + public explanation.

SECRETARY: administrative head + principal official adviser + process + continuity.

NORM: frank recorded lawful advice -> competent political decision -> faithful execution.

FAILURE: politicised compliance OR bureaucratic veto OR anonymous blame shifting.

PANEL 5/12 · CENTRAL SECRETARIAT AND HIERARCHY

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT = collective policy machinery, not one building/Cabinet Secretariat.

FUNCTIONS: policy -> Bills/rules -> budget -> consultation -> federal coordination

-> agency supervision -> Parliament/audit/courts -> records/evaluation.

COMMON CHAIN (varies):

Secretary -> Special/Additional Secretary -> Joint Secretary -> Director/Deputy Secretary

-> Under Secretary -> Section Officer -> Section staff.

RULE: dispose at lowest competent delegated level; every file need not reach apex.

PANEL 6/12 · FILE PROCEDURE AND DELEGATED LEGISLATION

receipt -> register/link precedent -> facts/law/options -> noting -> consultation
-> competent approval -> drafting -> authentication/issue -> record/monitor/review.
e-OFFICE changes medium, not competence; preserve cyber security, retention and one record.
PARENT ACT -> delegated power -> draft/consult -> competent rule-maker -> publish/lay
-> parliamentary subordinate-legislation scrutiny + judicial review.
AoB ownership alone does NOT create substantive rule-making power.

PANEL 7/12 · DELIVERY TAXONOMY

SECRETARIAT: policy/law/budget/coordination/oversight.

ATTACHED OFFICE: technical support and detailed executive direction (label is not decisive).

SUBORDINATE/FIELD OFFICE: execution/enforcement/service.

AUTONOMOUS BODY: instrument-defined managerial/financial space + ministry stewardship.

CPSE: company/statutory corporate form + ownership/commercial accountability.

STATUTORY BODY: powers/appointments/reporting/appeal from parent Act.

REGULATOR: statutory arm's-length rules/supervision/adjudication; no oral ministerial override.

PANEL 8/12 · CABINET SECRETARIAT / PMO / CABINET

PMO = direct staff support to Prime Minister.

CABINET = senior collective political decision body within Council.

CABINET COMMITTEE = selected ministers; standing/ad hoc; date-sensitive composition.

CABINET SECRETARIAT = Cabinet process + papers/records + AoB/ToB administration
+ decision monitoring + crisis/inter-ministerial coordination.

CABINET SECRETARY = administrative head; ex-officio Civil Services Board chair; not minister.

LIMIT: centre coordinates; line ministry retains lawful business and parliamentary ownership.

PANEL 9/12 · COORDINATION AND MISSIONS

shared outcome -> named lead department -> map affected subjects/finance/law/personnel/States
-> consultation -> concurrence OR recorded disagreement
-> CoS -> ministers/GoM -> Cabinet Committee/Cabinet as required
-> joint milestones + one accountable owner.

MISSION/PMU: sponsoring ministry + written terms + delegated rights + budget + records
+ conflict safeguards + sunset/mainstreaming.

TRAP: committee or PMU does not automatically receive statutory competence.

PANEL 10/12 · ACCOUNTABILITY WHEEL

PARLIAMENT: Art 75 responsibility, questions, motions, grants, DRSC.

FINANCE: appropriation, internal control, CAG -> PAC/Estimates/COPU.

LAW: parent Act, fundamental rights, natural justice, judicial review.

RULES: laying + Committee on Subordinate Legislation.

TRANSPARENCY/INTEGRITY: RTI, vigilance, Lokpal/CVC within jurisdiction, service discipline.

CITIZEN: grievance, charter, evaluation; not substitutes for legal remedy.

RECORD: file/e-Office reconstructs authority, consultation, reasons and decision.

PANEL 11/12 · REFORM AND ARC TEST

Second ARC 13th Report: rationalise functions; group related work; clearer policy/execution; accountable executive agencies; process simplification; delegation; coordination.

CURRENT TOOLS (bounded): delayering, e-Office, selective lateral entry, specialist teams.

SEVEN-PART TEST:

mandate -> authority/funds/people -> subsidiarity -> consultation -> capability

-> accountability -> transition (cadres/budgets/records/rules/pending cases).

ORGANOGRAM CHANGE != OUTCOME CHANGE.

PANEL 12/12 · PYQ ROUTE, TRAPS AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

2025 Prelims Q57: NAB->Heavy Industries; Coir->MSME; NCTI->Commerce; displayed pairs NONE.

2020 GS-II Q7: civil-service capability + tenure + recorded advice + department process.

2024 GS-II Q3: Cabinet majority/information vs Parliament's committees/finance/audit.

CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS:

President's name != personal decision; AoB != ToB; Ministry != Department;

Central Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat != PMO; Cabinet Committee != CoS;

autonomy != no accountability; e-Office != legal competence; Art 300 != blanket liability.

VERDICT: coordinate at the centre, decide at the lowest competent level, preserve one owner.